

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

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OPERA

Various user settings of Opera are stored in the Opera6.ini file located in the user's profile directory. Don't let the name Opera6.ini confuse you about the version of Opera this is meant to be used with. The version stated in the file name—6—corresponds to the version of the configuration file, not the browser. This file is automatically modified and saved when a user modifies any setting in the preferences of the browser. Likewise, if you open this file using a text editor such as Notepad, you can edit the settings and save the file for the settings to take effect the next time you launch Opera. We shall see how to go about tweaking this particular file to change the look, feel and functionality of Opera.

Warning

Opera should not be running while you edit Opera6.ini. Make a backup of Opera6.ini before you start editing this file in case you break it! Follow the syntax of these tips carefully. If you mess up, just replace the edited file with the backup you made, or just delete the edited file and launch Opera again to create a new file with default settings!

Find The File

In Opera, go to Help > About Opera. It will tell you the exact location of the Opera6.ini file. In the tweaks that follow, an integer value of 1 means True and 0 means False. Let's look at one section of the file at a time. The names of the sections are mentioned in square brackets, and the sections are thus easily recognisable.



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Let you didn't know

Emulate other browsers: Some Webmasters aren't catching up with the continuously-evolving browsers, and their Web sites, unfortunately, may refuse to function in any browser other than Internet Explorer. So, if you ever receive an error like "Browser not supported", go to Tools > Quick preferences > Identify as Internet Explorer or Identify as Mozilla.

[User Prefs]

Accept Cookies Session Only = 0

Some Web sites require you to accept cookies to use their services. If you want to make sure that sites work, while avoiding keeping cookies between visits, make Opera delete all cookies every time you close the browser by setting this value to 1.

AddressBar Alignment = 2

The position of the address bar in the browser window can be set using this setting. The different values to which it can be set and the corresponding different positions are: Off = 0, Left = 1, Top = 2, Right = 3, Bottom = 4

Allow Context Menus = 1

This setting lets you specify whether the context menu or right-click of the mouse should work in Opera. Setting this to 0 will disable right-clicking in the browser—this can be used by the system administrator to prevent users from using the context menu.

Allow script to change status = 1

This parameter can be used to disable JavaScript from performing certain actions such as manipulating the status bar of the browser window. This helps sometimes when JavaScript embedded in Web pages are used intrusively. Set this to 0 to disable JavaScript.

Allow script to hide address = 1

This parameter allows JavaScript to open tabs without a full address field, thus the address field is not visible. If you want to disable this feature, set this parameter to 0.

Allow script to lower window = 1 Allow script to raise window = 1

These parameters allow JavaScript to minimise or maximise pages of the browser. This feature is usually employed by aggressive advertising and porn sites to minimise other pages or maximise their page, so that only their page is visible to the user. You can turn this feature off by setting this value to 0.

Allow script to move window = 1

Once again, this is a feature that is used commonly by aggressive advertising and porn sites. You can disable this by setting the value to 0.

Allow script to receive right clicks = 0

This parameter allows JavaScript to override the default right-mouse click action configured in Opera. The JavaScript specified action will be performed instead when the value is set to 1.

A value of 0 here means "do not cache decoded images and chrome in memory." And if you put in a positive integer here, you're specifying a value manually. Naturally, you'd want to set the value depending on how much RAM you have, and on your browsing habits.